DVS7003 Data Visualisation
Assessment 1: Visualisation Critique

School of Computing, Northbridge University (2026-27, Teaching Block 1)

Key information

Weighting: 35% of the module mark.
Submission deadline: Monday 16 November 2026, 16:00 (UK time).
Submit a single PDF through the Assessment 1 submission point on the module page.
Word limit: 1,500 words, plus your redesign sketch.
Module leader: Dr Tomas Reyes (t.reyes@northbridge.example).

Overview

Choose one published chart or dashboard from a news site or a public report and critique it as a piece of communication.

The task

Your critique should first establish the intended audience of the visualisation and the decision it is meant to help them make, since every later judgement depends on it. With that in mind, you should evaluate the visual encoding choices, including the marks, channels, scales and layout, and explain how well each serves the reader.

Many published charts mislead without intending to. You are required to discuss any misleading or ineffective design you find, such as a truncated axis or a poor colour scale, and to explain what a reader is likely to conclude as a result. Your critique should end by recommending specific improvements, accompanied by a sketch of your redesign; a photographed hand drawing is acceptable.

Assessment criteria

Marks are allocated to audience and purpose (15%), the analysis of encoding (30%), misleading or ineffective design (30%), and the improvements and redesign (25%).